



## 10th Gup - 1st Dan Manual

This Manual Belongs to:

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Student Number: \_\_\_\_\_

Training Start Date: \_\_\_\_\_

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## **Welcome to Electric City Tang Soo Do!**

You've taken the first step on a journey that will lead you to a level of physical and mental self mastery that will influence every aspect of your life.

This manual has been prepared to help you on your journey. It outlines a basic timeline, etiquette, vocabulary, history, and rank requirements.

### **Introduction**

The martial art we teach is Tang Soo Do.

Tang Soo Do, founded by Hwang Kee around 1945, is a Korean martial art that combines elements of shotokan karate, subak, taekkyon, and kung fu.

Tang Soo Do is a classical martial art and not a sport. It is not a game to be played, but rather an activity designed to foster individual physical and mental growth.

### **Owner / Head Instructor**

Michael Simon began his Tang Soo Do training in 2003, under the direction of International Grandmaster Frank Trojanowicz (Dan #13333).

Michael has competed in Tournaments in the categories of Forms, Weapon Forms, Breaking, and Free Sparring, placing in many categories and specializing in Breaking.

Michael has been instructing children and adults since 2005.

## **Brief History of Martial Arts**

Martial arts themselves cannot be attributed to any one place or person. They developed naturally around the world when needed. Martial arts began as an individual instinct then developed into tribal systems and eventually evolved into the various styles and systems you see today. As martial arts progressed, ancient and modern Masters combined them with natural philosophies, based on a respect for nature, and focused on developing the practitioners into mature, centered human beings.

Although our martial art is relatively modern, its heritage goes back hundreds of years, combining the wisdom of China, Japan, Okinawa, Korea and combatives and philosophy from cultures all over the world.

From the wisdom of Confucius and Lao Tzu, to the code of the Samurai and the tenets of Korea's Hwa Rang warriors, Tang Soo Do's heritage and roots stretch far and wide.

Korean martial arts have a long and fascinating history, with many innovative pioneers.

Japan occupied Korea from 1910 to 1945. Its rule was oppressive and brutal; not many people realize that Japan decimated the Korean culture, much like their allies the Germans did to the Jews during the holocaust. Koreans were forced to speak only Japanese in public and had to adopt a Japanese name.

## **History Of Tang Soo Do**

Young Hwang Kee (황기|November 9, 1914 – July 14, 2002) born Tae Nam Hwang, into this tumultuous time, was one of Korea's greatest martial arts pioneers. He suffered many hardships but, at the age of seven, he saw something that changed his life.

While attending a village festival called 'Dan Oh', a group of ruffians began picking on a lone man. Suddenly this one man exploded into a flurry of kicks and spins defeating the attackers. Young Hwang Kee saw this person's amazing power against incredible odds and knew that he wanted to follow the same path. He approached this master of a martial art called 'Tae Kyun' but was rebuffed because he was too young. He spied on the Tae Kyun master's outdoor practice copying and learning in secret. For years, he trained in seclusion and sought out various Masters to learn from, but to no avail. Due to his father being a noted Korean scholar, young Hwang Kee was fortunate enough to be allowed to attend High school. Because of his good education, he was allowed to begin working for the Japanese controlled railroad: The Minami Manshū Tetsudō Kabushiki-gaisha(南満州鉄道株式会社/南満洲鉄道株式会社).

His job at the railroad allowed him to travel somewhat freely, and while working in Japanese controlled Manchuria China (also named "Manchukuo" at that time), his martial arts future took a dramatic turn.

As luck would have it, his job traveling led him to find his future teacher in Manchuria, in an area called Jo Yang Chun in the Gilum (Jilin) province. In 1936, Master Yang Kuk Jin (楊鞠振/楊鞠震) was a well known master of northern Kung Fu, particularly Tai Chi and Tan Tui. Originally Master Yang politely rebuffed young Hwang Kee and his coworker and friend Park Hyo Pil's requests to become his students. Not giving up, Hwang Kee and his friend kept showing up daily until Master Yang finally accepted them as students. Master Yang trained them in Bo Bup (stepping methods), Ryun Bup (conditioning methods), Dam Toi Ship Ee Ro (twelve long fist forms), and Tae Kuk Kwon (Tai Chi). Hwang Kee trained with Master Yang daily for a little over a year before having to return to Korea in 1937.

After the brutal Japanese occupation, Koreans wanted desperately to regain their identity. Hwang Kee, after his time training in China with Master Yang, began teaching in 1945 and originally promoted his style as Hwa Soo Do 花手道, or “flowering hand way”. The intended meaning was that students would grow, like a flower, into something beautiful. The name a nod to Korea’s Hwa Rang warriors as well. Remnants of the Japanese conditioning remained among the Korean population. His new style was not widely accepted and all his students quit. Disappointed, Hwang Kee searched for ways to continue teaching martial arts. As mentioned previously, Hwang Kee worked for the Korean Railroad, his coworkers Kim Un Chung, Kim Yong Duk and Choi Hee Suk had done some training during the Japanese occupation.

They began training with Hwang Kee in one of the small storage buildings owned by the Railroad. He realized from his past failed attempt at teaching Kung Fu (Hwa Soo Do) that he had hurdles to overcome.

He studied Karate books from the Railroad library. More than likely this was Gichin Funakoshis (船越 義珍) Karate Do Kyohan or his earlier works simply because Shotokan Karate was the only style of Karate permitted to be taught in Korea during the occupation.

Seeing how organized the Japanese Martial arts were, he befriended Lee Won Kuk a direct student of Funakoshi. Lee was the most successful Martial Arts instructor in Korea at that time and taught the Tang Soo Do Chung Do Kwan style. Tang Soo Do Chung Do Kwan was simply the Korean version of Japanese Shotokan style. This was evident in the use of kata (forms) & curriculum.

Hwang was so impressed with Lee's success he changed what he was teaching to Tang Soo Do and basically copied his curriculum. He did this understanding that the Korean people were not ready for something different like his first attempt Hwa Soo Do which resembled Kung Fu more than the Japanese style karate the Koreans were used to seeing at that time.

Now armed with a name (Tang Soo Do) and a curriculum borrowed from Chung Do Kwan, they were ready to teach. Hwang Kee assumed the leadership role as Kwan Jang Nim, as he was the head of the group and most experienced martial artist.

Since all four worked for the Korean railroad, they opened dojangs at various train station storage rooms & railroad owned buildings spreading their new organization. This allowed the organization to grow rapidly throughout Korea.

Hwang Kee's ability to harness his members resources helped them grow even further. He wrote various books, published a newspaper, and had a film produced for the American servicemen. He was way ahead of every other martial art style in Korea at the time.

In 1957, after seeing how well the Tang Soo Do style was accepted by American servicemen in Korea, Hwang Kee brilliantly tapped into this enthusiasm, eventually sending representatives to the USA to build an organization there. There was a charter meeting in 1975 to establish an organization in the USA for Tang Soo Do.



Pictured above are the participants of the charter meeting. Seated in the center is the founder of Tang Soo Do Grand Master (Kwan Jang Nim) Hwang Kee.

Seated on the floor, second from the right, is Grand Master Frank Trojanowicz, first instructor of Michael Simon, the owner of Electric City Tang Soo Do.

## **CLASS RULES**

The following rules shall be observed while attending classes at  
Electric City Tang Soo Do:

### **General Information**

- All monthly dues shall be paid on or before the 1st of every month.
- No shoes will be permitted on the Do Jang (training area or karate school) floor.
- Always wear a clean uniform.
- Tradition suggests that martial artists not wash the belt as it may remove rank or achievement stripes. Only wash belts on delicate cycle when needed.
- Never wear your Tang Soo Do belt without being in full uniform unless authorized by the instructor such as wearing a karate school t-shirt during the summer instead of the Do Bahk (uniform) jacket.
- Patches are to be displayed in the approved manner.
- Wearing watches, bracelets, and/or necklaces is prohibited. Wedding rings may be worn if turned inward or covered with tape. Only stud ear rings are permitted.

### **Attendance**

- All students must attend the required number of classes per week unless excused by the instructor to qualify for the next rank testing.
- Students should contact the instructor if they are going to be absent from regular class sessions, especially for multiple absences.
- Only one unexcused absence is permitted per month and must be made up to qualify for the next rank testing.
- Emergencies are an exception but you must notify the instructor as soon as possible following the absence.
- Family functions, school, work, and illness are excused absences.

### **Cleanliness**

- Practice good hygiene at all times.
- Keep fingernails and toenails trimmed, not only for good grooming, but also for safety.
- Wash hands before and after class.

### **Classroom Etiquette (Before Class)**

- Students should arrive 15 minutes before class to stretch and prepare.
- Upon entering the karate school, be sure to sign the sign in sheet to ensure you get credit for the classes you attend. If any of your personal or contact information has changed such as name, address, telephone number, or e-mail address, write down the updated information and write "New" next to your name and circle it or notify your instructor.
- When ready to enter the training floor, salute the flags by placing your right fist over your heart and then bow. This demonstrates respect and appreciation for our country and our art. You should do this upon entering and leaving the Do Jang
- After bowing onto the floor, use that time before the start of class to stretch, work on forms, grab a partner and work on one steps, or any other requirements you may need to work on.
- When first entering the Do Jang floor you should always recognize senior members, especially black belts. Greet them and bow. Shake hands if you choose.
- When shaking hands, extend your right arm to shake their hand and place your left hand palm open and down facing the floor under your right elbow.
- Never enter the Do Jang floor while a class is in progress or an instructor is engaged in teaching. Do not interrupt unless an emergency. Stand at the entry to the Do Jang floor and wait until the instructor acknowledges you and turns to bow you into the Do Jang floor. It is improper to attempt to get the Instructor's attention by speaking, a wave of the hand or other means. Wait quietly and patiently until you are acknowledged.
- When entering the Do Jang late stand at attention at the edge of the floor and do not enter the Do Jang floor until the instructor turns to you, bows, and acknowledges you to enter.
- If you enter the Do Jang after the class has begun and after you have been acknowledged and bowed in then you must line up at the end of the line on the back row unless otherwise instructed.
- When any master enters the Do Jang floor, any student must call attention to the master and turn and bow at once. This rule applies to any Tang Soo Do class, test, or Tang Soo Do function.
- All students waiting to begin class shall be respectful and remain quiet for other classes in session.
- No free sparring or use of equipment in the Do Jang without the approval of the instructor.
- **Parents are not allowed to instruct their children during class!!!**

### **Classroom Etiquette (During Class)**

- If leaving class early, or leaving room briefly, approach the instructor and ask for permission after bowing first, or discuss with instructor before class. Emergencies are always an exception.
- While on the Do Jang floor, instructors and black belts shall be addressed by Mr., Mrs., Miss, or Master while on the Do Jang floor.(also Sir, Ma'am, Kyo Sa Nim, Sa Bom Nim, Kwan Ja Nim, or Nim)
- No talking in class unless authorized by the class instructor.
- When training, try to clear your mind of any problems outside of the Do Jang.
- Bow before speaking to anyone on the Do Jang floor.
- When your belt or uniform needs to be straightened, bow, turn clockwise away from your instructor or other students while making the uniform or belt adjustments, then turn back and bow again, but only during an appropriate pause in instruction or training (always turn to the right and then back to the right making a complete circle).
- When asking a question in class raise your hand. When called upon bow to the instructor and ask your question. When your question has been answered say "Thank you Sir/Ma'am" and bow to the instructor. If seated when asking a question, raise your hand, when called upon stand, bow, and ask your question, after your question is answered say "Thank You Sir/Ma'am" bow to instructor and be seated.
- Turn off all cell phones in Do Jang.
- Keep temper and bad attitudes under control. Both are harmful not only to you, but to those who are training with you and they can cause accidents. There shall be no profanity used anywhere in the Do Jang.
- There shall be no alcohol or drugs consumed/used before or while attending class.
- No gum or food is allowed in the Do Jang; however, water or a hydrating drink is encouraged and may be kept at the side of the Do Jang floor or in a safe place so that it is not a hazard to other students.
- If a member of another Tang Soo Do school comes to visit, treat them as you would a member of your own school.
- If you attend class at another Tang Soo Do school, behave in a manner befitting your rank.

### **Classroom Etiquette (After Class)**

- When leaving the Do Jang floor, leave by rank in an orderly and calm manner. Turn to the Do Jang floor from the exit, bow, and salute the flags before leaving.
- If the instructor has asked you to assist in cleanup of any kind please do so without fuss or hesitation. This is part of your training and is expected of all students. You should take pride in your Do Jang as it is where you learn and grow in the martial arts.

### **Outside the Classroom**

- It is not permitted to use Tang Soo Do techniques outside of class unless it is a true instance of self-defense. All use of Tang Soo Do techniques outside the classroom must be reported to the Master in charge of the Do Jang.
- Never wear your uniform or belt outside of class. Uniform pants may be worn to and from the Do Jang.
- Do not engage in any activity that might degrade your reputation as you represent the school.
- All students must be gang free.

At Electric City Tang Soo Do we teach our students to live by the following:

#### **5 Codes of Tang Soo Do**

- 1) Loyalty to Country
- 2) Obedience to Parents
- 3) Honor Friendship
- 4) No Retreat in Battle
- 5) In Conflict, Choose with Sense & Honor

#### **7 Tenets of Tang Soo Do**

- 1) Integrity
- 2) Concentration
- 3) Perseverance
- 4) Respect & Obedience
- 5) Self Control
- 6) Humility
- 7) Indomitable spirit

### **5 Codes of Tang Soo Do**

1. **Loyalty to country** - Country implies community, neighbor, society, country.  
( faithfulness, devotion, sincerity, patriotism, contribution )
2. **Obedience to parents** - Parents implies father, mother, teacher, elders, and instructors. (respect for others, esteem, honor, appreciation. )
3. **Honor friendship** - Friends implies associates, colleagues, brothers, sisters.  
( brotherhood, sisterhood, trust, unity, responsibility, credibility, humility. )
4. **No retreat in battle** - Battle signifies job, duty, responsibility, goal, ideal.  
( determination, perseverance, duty, courage. )
5. **In conflict, choose with sense and honor** - Conflict can mean use of Tang Soo Do to defend oneself or others, it can also mean and internal or moral conflict.  
( humanity, mercy, wisdom. )

### **7 Tenets of Tang Soo Do**

1. **Integrity** – The quality of being honest and having strong moral principles.  
(Always do the right thing)
2. **Concentration** - The action or power of focusing one's attention or mental effort. (Focus on what you're doing and don't get distracted)
3. **Perseverance** - Steadfastness in doing something despite difficulty or delay in achieving success. (Never give up as no matter how hard things get)
4. **Respect and Obedience** - a feeling of deep admiration for someone or something elicited by their abilities, qualities, or achievements. AND compliance with an order, request, or law or submission to another's authority. (we treat everyone the way we want to be treated and listen to those in authority)
5. **Self-Control** - the ability to control oneself, in particular one's emotions and desires or the expression of them in one's behavior, esp. in difficult situations.  
(Control your self. Restraint and concentration are examples)
6. **Humility** - a modest or low view of one's own importance; humbleness. (Don't be boastful or show off)
7. **Indomitable Spirit** - a spirit that cannot be subdued or overcome, as persons, will, or courage; unconquerable. (Be strong inside and never let things stop you from achieving your goals)

## **Korean Terminology**

### **General Terminology**

|                       |                                                |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Tang Soo Do .....     | Name of the art we study                       |
| Nim.....              | Term of respect (i.e. Sir or Ma'am)            |
| Kwan Jang Nim .....   | Grand Master                                   |
| Sa Bom Nim .....      | Master Instructor (4 <sup>th</sup> Dan and up) |
| Kyo Sa Nim.....       | Instructor (2 <sup>nd</sup> Dan and up)        |
| Jo Kyo Nim .....      | Assistant Instructor                           |
| Shim Sa Kwan Nim..... | Judge/Examiner                                 |
| Dan .....             | Black belt rank                                |
| Gup .....             | Color belt rank                                |
| Do Jang.....          | Training Hall (school/studio)                  |
| Do Bahk .....         | Uniform                                        |
| Dee.....              | Belt                                           |
| Kuk Gi .....          | Flag                                           |
| Hyung.....            | Form                                           |
| Ki Hap .....          | Yell                                           |

### **Commands In Starting And Ending Class**

|                            |                 |
|----------------------------|-----------------|
| Cha Ryut.....              | Attention       |
| Kuk Gi Bae Reh .....       | Salute the flag |
| Ba Ro .....                | Return          |
| An Ju.....                 | Sit             |
| Muk Nyum .....             | Meditation      |
| (Title)Keh Kyung Nyet..... | Bow to (Title)  |

## **Commands In Training**

Kyung Nyet..... Bow  
Choon Bee .....Ready (get into Choon Bee Jaseh)  
Si Jak .....Begin  
Shio.....Relax  
Dwi Ro Tora .....Turn to rear

## **Stances**

Choon Bee Jaseh ..... Ready Stance  
Chun Gul Jaseh..... Front Stance  
Hu Gul Jaseh..... Fighting Stance  
Kee Ma Jaseh..... Horse Stance

## **Korean Numbers**

Ha Na .....One  
Dool.....Two  
Set ..... Three  
Net ..... Four  
Da Sot.....Five  
Yuh Sot..... Six  
Il Gop .....Seven  
Yo Dull ..... Eight  
Ah Hap..... Nine  
Yohl..... Ten

## **Basic Action Commands**

Mahk Kee ..... Block  
Kong Kyuk..... Attack  
Cha Gi..... Kick  
Ha Dan.....Low section  
Choong Dan .....Middle section  
Sang Dan..... High Section

## **Blocks**

Ha Dan Mahk Kee.....Low block  
Sang Dan Mahk Kee ..... High block  
Ahneso Pahkuro Mahk Kee..... Inside-Outside block  
Pahkeso Ahnero Mahk Kee ..... Outside-Inside block

## **Hand Techniques**

Choong Dan Kong Kyuk..... Middle punch  
Sang Dan Kong Kyuk.....High punch  
Kwan Soo Kong Kyuk .....Spear hand  
Soo Do Kong Kyuk ..... Knife hand  
Yuk Soo Do Kong Kyuk .....Ridge hand/reverse knife hand  
Cap Kwon ..... Back fist  
Kwon Do ..... Hammer fist

(\*To indicate a block from a stance other than front stance the name of the stance is added to the beginning of the above I.e. Hu Gul Ha Dan Mahk Kee or low block in fighting stance)

## **Kicks**

(\*The addition of the term E Dan indicates a jumping kick)

Ahp Cha Nut Gi.....Front kick  
Yup Cha Gi..... Side kick  
Dullyo Cha Gi..... Round kick  
Dwi Cha Gi ..... Back kick  
Ahneso Pakero Cha Gi ..... Inside-Outside kick  
Pakeso Ahnero Cha Gi ..... Outside-Inside kick  
Yup Hu Ri Gi..... Hook kick  
Peet Cha Gi..... Reverse round kick

## **Courtesy and Respect**

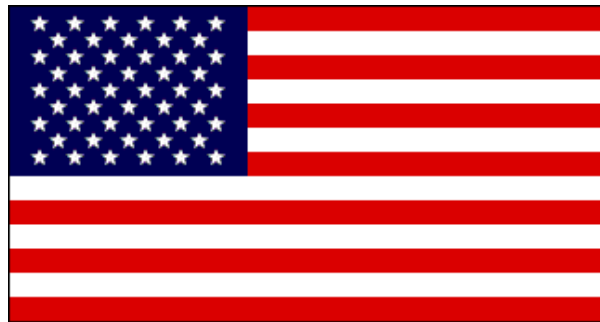
Kahm Sa Ham Ni Da.....Thank you

All of the above terms may be used in class. The pronunciations are not given, so you may learn them by hearing them. This chart is simply used for reference.



## **Flags and Meanings**

### **American Flag**



The 50 stars represent the number of states. The 13 alternating white and red stripes represent the original 13 colonies. The colors of the flag have meaning as well: Red symbolizes Hardiness and Valor. White symbolizes Purity and Innocence. Blue represents Vigilance, Perseverance and Justice.

### **South Korean Flag**



The white background represents purity and peace or emptiness. The concept of emptiness is an important one in martial arts because one must empty ones mind or preconceived notions before true learning and growth can occur. In the center of the flag lies a Taegeuk, a symbol for balance and harmony. The symbols ,or trigrams, in the corners are known as kwae and are taken from the ancient book of thought , the Chu Yok (Chinese I Ching). Representing the four classical elements and the seasons, They are heaven/spring (3 solid bars), fire/autumn (2 solid bars with split middle bar), water /winter (2 split bars with solid middle bar) and earth/summer (3 split bars).

## **Uniform**

The Uniform is properly called a Do Bahk. This is a composite word, combining Do “way of life” and Bahk “apparel” or “clothing.”

The word “Gi” is the Japanese term for uniform and is inappropriate for use in our art.

The Do Bok is the symbol of your commitment to mental and physical self-improvement. The traditional white color of the Do Bok has been maintained since ancient times. The white color represents the practitioner’s respect for life, purity of spirit and commitment to avoid unjust conflict. You should always wear your Do Bok with pride and respect it as you do your own body. Keep it clean and in good shape. To be proud of your outside appearance can only mean you feel good on the inside.

## **Patches**

All patches should be attached to your uniform as soon as possible

Wash the uniform in cold water before sewing the patches on the student uniform.

Do not wash the belt.

Do not wash or dry the uniform on hot. The uniform may shrink.

Cold water wash is best.

Use clear mailing tape or straight pins, place the patch at the center shoulder seam and down about one inch. Stitches should be close together so that the patch does not curl at the edges. White quilting thread is good for sewing on the patches.

**Chest Patch** – Tape or pin this patch on while the uniform top is being worn by the student. Tie the belt on before positioning the patch. Tie the top as it should be worn. Tie at the sides. Tie the belt around the waist and pin the patch in place.

The patch is worn over the area of the heart on the left front panel.

**Association Patch** - Should be attached in the same manner as above but on the arm of the uniform right below the shoulder seam. (optional)

### **Additional Information:**

Hem the sleeves and the pants if necessary. The uniform should not be worn with the sleeves or the pants rolled up for safety reasons. (Please talk to instructor if you feel your child may grow quickly and you don't want to hem the uniform)

2. Once the patches have been sewn onto the uniform - do not wash with bleach as it will fade the patches.
3. Keep your uniform clean. (not necessarily freshly washed but free of stains and odor). Your uniform is to be worn only at class.
4. A plain tee shirt is to be worn under the uniform top. The tee shirt must be presentable outer wear not underwear. The school tee shirt may be worn under the top.
5. All students must wear underpants or shorts under the uniform pants.
6. Very important – no jewelry made from metal, plastic, clothe, string, paper...This is a safety issue. Our aim is to keep the students safe. Speak with instructor if you have any questions.
7. Hygiene and safety of all members - keep fingernails and toenails clean, short, and file all sharp edges smooth.

## **The Belt**

The belt also known as Dee in Korean is an important part of your uniform. It not only helps to hold your uniform together but it gives you an idea of where you are on your journey in the martial arts.

Your belt should never be washed.

Make sure your rank stripes, if any, hang to the left when your belt is tied

### **How to tie your belt\***

Often times newer students lose focus during class times to tie their belt. This little “how to” will help you learn how to tie your belt successfully so that you only need do it once per lesson

1. Before you tie your belt make sure your jacket is tied correctly and securely.
2. Fold your belt in half.
3. Open the belt and place the half way point slightly below your bellybutton (if you have a rank stripe it should hang on on the right side)
4. Wrap the belt ends around your back, cross them and bring them around to the front. Slide your hands along the belt to make sure it doesn't twist. Ends should be the same length when brought to the front.
5. Cross both ends in front of you with the right end on top.
6. Take the top end and tuck it underneath both layers of the belt and up towards your face, this should be now the nearest part to your abdomen.
7. To finish simply tie a knot. Both ends should hang at equal length (Rank stripes on the left, achievement stripes on the right)

\*Keep in mind the best way to learn is to ask your instructor to teach you.

In our school we keep with the tradition of this 10 level system. Below you will find the belt system laid out and the meanings of the different colored belts:

10th Gup White Belt

\*9th Gup White Belt with one stripe\*

8th Gup Orange Belt

\*7th Gup Orange Belt with one stripe\*

6th Gup Green Belt

5th Gup Green Belt with one stripe

4th Gup Green Belt with two stripes

3rd Gup Red Belt

2nd Gup Red Belt with one stripe

1st Gup Red Belt with two stripes

Cho Dan Bo or Red Belt with three stripes (designates a student training for black belt test)

1st Dan or 1st Degree Black Belt - 3rd Dan or 3rd Degree Black Belt (designated by rank stripes)

4th Dan or 4th Degree Black Belt and above are considered master ranks and are designated by a red stripe through the center of the belt.

\*ranks with this designation are not normally tested for but awarded in class or rolled into the next belt level test.

\*\*the tradition of using a midnight blue belt is also very popular to replace the black belt . At our school students are given the option to use black, midnight blue, or both styles.

**The four original colors were:**

**White** is Winter it signifies emptiness, innocence, hidden potential, and purity

**Green** is Spring it signifies growth, spreading, advancement

**Red** is Summer it signifies ripening, “yang”, active

**Black** is Autumn it signifies harvest, maturity, “um”, passive

\*many people have added colors along the way. Orange was added in 1975 to give another stepping stone for students to lessen the amount of material between white and green belt.

\* as a note the terms “yang” and “um” correspond to the red and blue in the Korean flag. Yang being the red, hard aspects of our style. Um being the blue, softer aspects of our style



## **Elements of Tang Soo Do Training**

### **Hyungs**

Hyungs or forms are an integral part of Tang Soo Do training. Hyungs are a set of moves demonstrating a defensive or aggressive action for every movement. They are based on an offender attacking and one demonstrating the form reacting to their attack. The training of forms gives you an opportunity to work all aspects of the martial arts, including focus, timing, balance, etc. Forms also give you a chance to work on all of your physical techniques (i.e. kicks, blocks, etc.)

Some points about Hyung training

- Concentration is essential
- Every attempt at a Hyung requires maximum effort
  - Perfection requires continues practice
- Patience is as important as physical ability in developing a perfect Hyung
- Develop your own psychological technique to overcome idleness, distractions, and mental block.
- After practice learn to relax and to appreciate the gains you have made, no matter how small.

### **One Steps**

These techniques are developed by individual instructors and are not standard in Tang Soo Do. One-step sparring techniques are best described as a choreographed pattern of defense moves against the single step of an attack. Usually performed in pairs, this begins with a bow for respect. One partner then attacks, often with a simple punch, and the other person will perform a series of premeditated techniques.

### **Weapons**

Tang Soo Do does not traditionally have weapons. Some schools have added weapons training to their curriculum. In our school we teach staff, knife, and sword.

### **Point-Sparring**

Tang Soo Do point-sparring is similar to competitive matches in other traditional Okinawan, Japanese and Korean striking systems and may include elements of American freestyle point karate. Tang Soo Do sparring consists of point matches that are based on the three-point rule (the first contestant to score three points wins) or a two-minute rule (a tally of points over one two-minute round). Lead and rear-leg kicks and lead and rear-arm hand techniques all score equally (one point per technique). However, to encourage the use of jumping and spinning kicks, these techniques may be scored with a higher point value than standing techniques in some competitions. Most point sparring events have their own unique rules outlining forbidden techniques and scoring.

### **Free Sparring**

Free Sparring is similar to point sparring but no score is kept. No contact to light or moderate contact is used and students simulate a real fight using all techniques they have learned and reacting to their opponents techniques.

### **Self Defense**

Self Defense techniques just as One Steps are developed by individual instructors and are not standard in Tang Soo Do. They are simulations of situations where one must defend themselves or others from harm. Either against a punch, kick, grab, or hold of some sort.

### **Breaking**

Board breaking using different kicks and hand strikes traditionally is done during promotional testing. Breaking demonstrates correct application of technique, power, and focus. A person can have great power, but if he or she lacks focus or technique, they will not break. As you progress through the ranks your breaking requirements become more difficult.

## **What is a stance?**

A stance is whatever posture your body is in, in that moment. Over the years martial arts masters have come to realize which postures are the most effective. By observing human movement and applying natural laws ancient martial arts masters have helped develop and systemize what techniques work most effectively.

Stances can be static or dynamic. The goal of the stance is for you to maintain enough balance to either effectively defend yourself or attack your opponent.

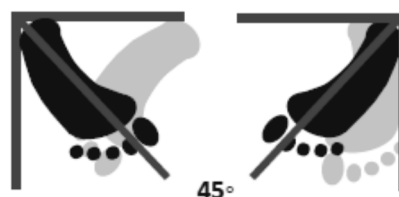
The effectiveness of your stance will greatly impact each and every technique you do. It is your foundation. Improve your foundation and everything you do will improve, ignore your foundation and everything you do will suffer. By making even a small improvement in your stances everything you do will get better.

## **Measurements**

In Tang Soo Do Volume one Grandmaster Hwang Kee used actual measurements in the form of metrics to give examples of distances in stances. The challenge with that is everyone is of differing sizes and shapes so unless you are the same exact size as the model for which he based these measurements on you would need to recalculate the distances for yourself.

In this manual we will be using our own foot measurements for the exact distances for each stance. Since your own feet are your own base this is both practical and customized to your individual needs. Note the measurements are to teach you the distance. This is NOT how you regularly enter the stances.

For our needs we will break the pivots down to a) toes out (one pivot), b) toes in (one pivot), and c) toes straight (1/2 pivot). Each pivot the feet will move 45 degrees and on the half pivot turn straight ahead.



## **Stances**

The main stances used in Tang Soo Do are Ready Stance/Choon Bee Jaseh, Front Stance/Chun Gul Jaseh, Fighting Stance/Hu Gul Jaseh, and Horse Stance/Kee Ma Jaseh.

For all stances the starting position, unless otherwise noted, will be attention stance. Attention stance would be having hands at your side, back up straight, and your feet together.

## **Stance Energetics**

The study of the stances cannot be fully addressed without discussing the energetics of the stances. Unnecessary tension or misplaced tension in the body can throw one off balance. Grandmaster Hwang Kee was fond of quoting this line from the song of the thirteen energies. "Imagine the head as if suspended by a string." This simple statement is a profound one and if fully understood can dramatically improve your training, health and life. Think of a weight held by a string, a pendulum if you will. The string will be naturally straight and in harmony with the forces of gravity because of the downward pulling force. Applying this concept to our posture will naturally straighten the spine and correct poor postural habits.

Mental focus should also be on the Dan Jun (abdomen) when training as to not allow tension/energy to rise and make one top heavy or stiff. Imagine throwing a ball. You transfer your weight, the arm is relaxed, the ball is released, and the arm is still relaxed. Relaxation is key to throwing correctly. Now when executing a punch if you are too tense it will slow down the motion. If you are tense after you waste energy. So we need to understand when to tense and when to relax to maximize our power and use of our energy properly.

## Ready Stance/Choon Bee Jaseh



Choon Bee Jaseh is one and a half foot pivots from the attention stance equaling one shoulder widths. This is your everyday standing stance.

The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the center-line over the middle of the base. Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun (center) as upper body tension will cause you to be top heavy and unstable. Fists should be around waist level roughly a fists distance away from each other and a fists distance from your body

The Choon Bee/Pa Ro Jaseh (ready/return stance) can also be two and one half foot pivots for more stability. Find the position you are comfortable in. these measurements are more guidelines to help you find the proper distance for your stances more so than hard and fast rules.



1



2



3

## Fighting Stance/Hu Gul Jaseh



Hu Gul Jaseh is one and a half foot pivots from the attention stance equaling one shoulder width. Then the heel is pivoted with the majority of the weight shifted to one leg while the ball of the opposite foot lightly rests on the ground. The knees should be bent so when looking down you do not see your toes. The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the middle of the base (in this case the balancing leg). Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun (center).



1



2



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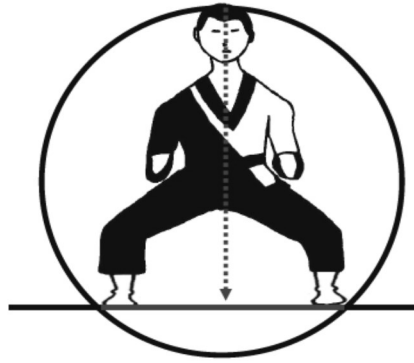


4



5

## Horse Stance/ Kee Ma Jaseh



Kee Ma Jaseh is 3 ½ foot pivots from the attention stance equaling two shoulder widths. The knees should be bent so when looking down you do not see your toes. The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the middle of the base. Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun (center) as upper body tension will cause you to be top heavy and unstable. Think as if you are sitting in a horse's saddle so your weight is constantly pushing down verse holding a static posture like a cardboard cutout.



1



2



3



4



5

## Front Stance/ Chun Gul Jaseh



From the Kee Ma Jaseh (horse stance) pivot on the balls of the feet 45°. Shift the weight forward towards the front leg until if looking down you cannot see your toes. The rear leg will then naturally straighten. The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the base. Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun (center) as upper body tension will cause you to be top heavy and unstable. Think as if you were pushing something forward with your hips.

Your head, shoulder, hips, and feet should all point forward.



1



2



3



4



5



6

## **Testing**

A student's eligibility to test is determined by their instructor. The instructor evaluates many aspects of the student's training for consideration for rank advancement.

For example, overall performance, attendance, behavior, maturity, etc.

- A promotion test will be offered every 3 months for those students who qualify.
  - Students will be notified in advance if they qualify for testing.
  - **TESTING FEES ARE NOT INCLUDED IN THE MONTHLY TUITION!!!!**
- At test time, if not already paid, have your testing fees ready before you sign in.
- During test days, absolutely no talking is permitted in the Do Jang or Do Jang waiting area, except for speaking directly with the instructor or members of the exam board at the test table and only for the purpose of conducting testing business.
- All class etiquette rules apply during testing, except there will be no talking.

## **Certifications**

In addition to rank certification, students may be awarded teaching certifications.

**Jo Kyo** or Assistant Instructor certification may be awarded at the red belt level.

Minimum age requirement is 13.

**Kyo sa** or Instructor certification may be awarded at the 2nd Dan level.

Minimum age requirement is 21.

**Sa Bom** or Master Instructor certification may be awarded at the 4th Dan level.

Minimum age requirement is 25.

## **Rank Requirements**

Basic rank requirements are listed for each belt level on the following pages. Requirements may be amended at anytime based on the instructor's discretion or as an assessment of individual student limitations.

**10<sup>th</sup> Gup White-8<sup>th</sup> Gup Orange Belt Requirements**  
**(9<sup>th</sup> Gup is a white with 1 stripe, it is only tested for if necessary)**

**Forms:**

Gi Cho Hyung Il Bu  
Gi Cho Hyung Ee Bu  
Gi Cho Hyung Sam Bu

**Hand Techniques:**

Low Block  
High Block  
Middle Punch  
High Punch  
Inside to Outside Block

**Foot Techniques:**

Front Stretch Kick  
Front Snap Kick  
Round House Kick  
Inside to Outside Kick

**One Steps Hand:**

#1-#4

**One Steps Foot:**

#1-#4

**Breaks:**

Elbow Strike/Front Kick  
Hammer Fist/Knife Hand

**Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Name of the art you study
2. Do Jang
3. Do Bahk
4. Protocol for entering and leaving the Do Jang

**8<sup>th</sup> Gup Orange-6<sup>th</sup> Gup Green Belt Requirements**  
**(7<sup>th</sup> Gup is Orange with 1 stripe, not normally tested for)**

**Forms:**

Pyung Ahn Cho Dan  
Bong Hyung Il Bu

**Hand Techniques:**

Outside To Inside Block  
Side Punch  
Elbow Attack  
Low Knife Hand Block  
Two Fist Middle Block  
Hammer Fist Strike

**Foot Techniques:**

Side Stretch Kick  
Side Kick  
Jump Front Kick  
Outside to Inside Kick  
Back Kick

**One Steps Hand:**

#5 & #6

**One Steps Foot:**

#5 & #6

**Breaks:**

Step Behind Side Kick, Spinning Back Kick, or Palm Strike

**Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Count from 1-10 in Korean
2. 5 Codes and 7 Tenets
3. Commands for starting class
4. Kyung Reh
5. Si Jak

## **6<sup>th</sup> Green-5<sup>th</sup> Green (1 Stripe) Belt Requirements**

### **Forms:**

Pyung Ahn Ee Dan  
Tando Hyung So

### **Hand Techniques:**

Middle Knife Hand Block  
Low Two Hand Block  
Spear Hand Strike

### **Foot Techniques:**

Jump Side Kick

### **One Steps Hand:**

#7 & #8

### **One Steps Foot:**

#7 & #8

### **Breaks:**

Double Break:  
Middle Punch/Step behind Side Kick

### **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Why do you bow before entering the Do Jang?
2. Belt colors and meanings
3. Sa Bom Nim, Kyo Sa Nim, and Jo Kyo Nim

## **5<sup>th</sup> Gup Green (1 Stripe)-4<sup>th</sup> Gup Green (2 Stripes) Requirements**

### **Forms:**

Pyung Ahn Sam Dan  
Bong Hyung Ee Bu

### **Hand Techniques:**

High Knife Hand Block  
High Two Hand Block

### **Foot Techniques:**

Hook Kick

### **One Steps Hand:**

#9 & #10

### **One Steps Foot:**

#9 & #10

### **Breaks:**

Double Break:  
Knife Hand/Spinning Back Kick  
Round Kick

### **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Basic Terminology

## **4<sup>th</sup> Gup Green (2 Stripes)-3<sup>rd</sup> Gup Red Requirements**

### **Forms:**

Pyung Ahn Sa Dan

### **Hand Techniques:**

Back Fist

### **Foot Techniques:**

Spinning Axe Kick

Jump Roundhouse Kick

Jump Inside to Outside Kick

### **One Steps Hand:**

#11 & #12

### **One Steps Foot:**

#11 & #12

### **Breaks:**

Hook Kick

Jump Back Kick

## **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Basic history of Tang Soo Do

### **3<sup>rd</sup> Red-2<sup>nd</sup> Red (1 Stripe) Belt Requirements**

#### **Forms:**

Pyung Ahn Oh Dan

#### **Hand Techniques:**

All lower level techniques

#### **Foot Techniques:**

Jump Back Kick  
Jump Spinning Axe Kick  
Jump Spinning Hook Kick

#### **One Steps Hand:**

#13 & #14

#### **One Steps Foot:**

#13 & #14

#### **Breaks:**

Double Break:

Standing or Step Behind Side Kick/Step Behind Hook Kick with opposite leg  
Ridge Hand

### **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Essay: The 5 codes

## **2<sup>nd</sup> Gup Red (1 Stripe)-1<sup>st</sup> Gup Red (2 Stripes) Belt Requirements**

### **Forms:**

Bassai So  
Tando Hyung Dae

### **Hand Techniques:**

All lower level Techniques

### **Foot Techniques:**

Reverse Round Kick

### **Kicks:**

Spinning Axe Kick with the back leg in Fighting Stance  
Jump Spinning Hook Kick (360) off the back leg with a fake in Fighting Stance

### **One Steps Hand:**

#15 & #16

### **One Steps Foot:**

#15 & #16

### **Breaks:**

Double Break:  
Ridge Hand/Jump Spinning Back Kick (Right Leg)

### **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Essay: The 7 Tenets

## **1<sup>st</sup> Gup Red (2 Stripes)-Cho Dan Bo (3 Stripes) Belt Requirements**

### **Forms:**

Bassai Dae  
Bong Hyung Sam Bu

### **One Steps Hand:**

#17 & #18

### **One Steps Foot:**

#17 & #18

### **Breaking:**

Breaking is not required for this rank.

### **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Essay: What does Tang Soo Do mean to me?

## **Cho Dan Bo (3 Stripes)-1<sup>st</sup> Dan - Cho Dan Requirements**

### **Forms:**

Nai Hanji Cho Dan

### **Kicks:**

Spinning Axe Kick with the back leg in Fighting Stance

Jump Spinning Hook Kick (360) off the back leg with a fake in Fighting Stance

### **One Steps Hand:**

#19 & #20

### **One Steps Foot:**

#19 & #20

### **10 Self Defense:**

1. 2 hand neck grab.
2. Same side wrist grab.
3. Double wrist grab.
4. Neck grab from behind.
5. Double wrist grab from behind.
6. Bear hug from behind (arms trapped).
7. Bear hug from behind (arms free).
8. Hair grab.
9. Head lock (head under arm).
10. Double lapel grab.

### **Breaks:**

Standing Jump Side Kick (Chest or Above)

### **Endurance:**

30 seconds of continuous punching in Kee Ma Jaseh. Focus on power, speed, and proper direction on hip for maximum effectiveness of each punch. The goal is 120 punches with proper technique and form.

### **Culture, Terminology, and History**

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Essay: What does being a black belt mean to me?

## **Notes**

## **Testing Record**

This manual must be handed in at each test so this testing record can be kept up to date.

The testing date and official seal will be placed on this page and the manual will be returned with your new rank certificate.

|                                                                 |                                                   |                                                                  |                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>9th Gup</u></b><br>White 1 Stripe<br><br>Awarded in class | <b><u>8th Gup</u></b><br>Orange<br><br>           | <b><u>7th Gup</u></b><br>Orange 1 Stripe<br><br>Awarded in class | <b><u>6th Gup</u></b><br>Green<br><br>        |
| <b><u>5th Gup</u></b><br>Green 1 Stripe<br><br>                 | <b><u>4th Gup</u></b><br>Green 2 Stripes<br><br>  | <b><u>3rd Gup</u></b><br>Red<br><br>                             | <b><u>2nd Gup</u></b><br>Red 1 Stripe<br><br> |
| <b><u>1st Gup</u></b><br>Red 2 Stripes<br><br>                  | <b><u>Cho Dan Bo</u></b><br>Red 3 Stripes<br><br> | <b><u>Pre Test</u></b><br><br><br>                               | <b><u>1st Dan</u></b><br><br><br>             |

